RecruitGPT.ai: Production Readiness Estimate

Time needed to take the product from the current working build to a launch-ready, paying-customer platform. Includes the planned second login (candidate portal).

5 to 7 weeks

with 2 developers working in parallel (7 to 10 weeks with 1 developer). Effort is estimated for a team using AI coding assistants (ChatGPT / Claude). About **33 to 53 developer-days** of work, plus waiting time on approvals that no amount of extra development speeds up.

Where the project stands today

The recruiter product is feature-complete and running: self-serve web app with accounts, workspaces and roles; sourcing, scoring and briefs; outreach with a human approval gate; inbox watch; interview scheduling; client acquisition; Stripe billing with three plan types; a local browser helper with one-click installers; a platform admin console; and 46 automated tests (tenant isolation, approval gate, security boundaries, billing, imports). What remains is mostly **validation against real services, a second login for candidates, and launch hardening**, not core building.

Effort breakdown

Work package	Days	What it involves
Recruiter product		
Connect and test real services	2 to 3	Claude, Stripe, Google, Quo SMS, Apollo, Exa. Code exists; time goes on accounts and fixing mismatches.
LinkedIn / Indeed validation	5 to 10	Biggest risk. Needs a licensed account; page selectors need real-site testing and adjustment.
Tune scoring and outreach quality	3 to 5	Review with Carlos against the real recruiting rules; adjust prompts and rubric.
Candidate login (new)		
Candidate portal	7 to 10	Separate login and dashboard; profile, resume upload and grading, AI coach, job matching, application tracking.
Candidate billing and consultations	3 to 5	Candidate subscription tiers, paid 1:1 sessions with scheduling (reuses existing Stripe and calendar code).
Candidate-to-recruiter link	2 to 3	Consent / opt-in, recruiters finding opted-in candidates, privacy controls.
Launch hardening		
QA, security, password reset	5 to 7	Browser tests across both portals, security review, load test, password reset and email verification.
Deployment and operations	3 to 5	Domains, TLS, hosting, staging, monitoring, backup restore test, secrets management.
Installer testing	2 to 3	Clean Windows / Mac / Linux machines; code signing.
Move Carlos's real data	1 to 2	Import of the existing database. Needs access to it.
Total	**33 to 53**	Pilot with Carlos and early users runs in parallel (about 2 weeks).

Suggested timeline

Weeks	Milestone	Outcome
1 to 3	Recruiter pilot	Real accounts connected, LinkedIn / Indeed validated, scoring tuned with Carlos. Pilot with Carlos begins.
3 to 5	Candidate portal	Candidate login, resume grading and coach, job matching, applications, plans and consultations working.
5 to 7	Launch hardening	QA and security fixes, deployment, monitoring and backups proven, installers tested. Ready for paying customers.

Waiting on others (not developer time)

• **Google approval** for sending email on customers' behalf: typically 2 to 6 weeks. Apply on day one; it runs in parallel.

• **Lawyer review** of terms, privacy and the LinkedIn / Indeed compliance statement: 1 to 2 weeks. The candidate side adds a second privacy policy.

• **Business decisions:** prices for solo and white-label plans, candidate plan terms, trial length, usage rates.

Key risks

- **LinkedIn / Indeed automation** is the make-or-break item. It depends on how the sites behave in real use and on their terms of service. This is the main reason the range is wide; it should be tested first.
- **Google verification delay** could push public launch past week 7 even if development finishes on time. Until approved, email sending is limited to test users.
- **Candidate side architecture.** The scope document describes it as a separate sister app. Building it inside the same app is faster; a fully separate app adds about 1 week.
- **Recruiting logic provenance.** The scoring rules and prompts are our own implementation, not Carlos's originals. They need his review before launch.

Assumptions

- AI-assisted development throughout. Estimates would be roughly 2 to 3 times longer without it.
- Accounts, API keys and a licensed LinkedIn / Indeed seat are available in week 1. Each day of delay moves the date by a day.
- Candidate portal is built in the same codebase and database as the recruiter product, as a separate login and dashboard, covering the features listed for CandidateGPT in the scope document.
- No major scope change after sign-off. Items not in the scope document (for example mobile apps) are excluded.